the campaign trail only two weeks or so, there was so much tension and bickering that I decided to call the key players together at my house in Pacific Palisades to see if I could smooth things over.

As soon as they got there, Sears, Jim Lake, and Charles Black, in effect, gave me an ultimatum: Mike Deaver had to go. They said he had too much authority and was often working at cross purposes to what they wanted to accomplish in the campaign. This put me in the position of having to choose between Mike and the three of them, but before I could say anything, Mike spoke up:

"Look, if it comes down to a choice between me and John, I don't believe you can afford to lose John, and I'll leave."

With that, Mike stood up and walked out of the living room. He had helped bring John Sears on to the team and believed in his capabilities completely and was willing to sacrifice himself.

I ran after Mike and caught up with him at the front door and tried to persuade him to stay. But he said, "No, Governor, you need John Sears more than you need me."

When I returned to the living room, I was very upset. "Damn it," I said, "you've just driven away someone who's probably a better man than the three of you are."

With Mike gone, the friction on the staff began to subside—for a while—and the campaign began to pick up steam.

When I'd announced my decision to run for the Republican presidential nomination, the field was already crowded; with seven candidates already in the race, it promised to be a *long* campaign.

As I had in 1976, I told my campaign staff that I intended to abide by the Eleventh Commandment: I'd attack only Democrats while trying to let the voters know where I stood.

I figured I would deal with the skepticism that some Northeasterners had about me simply by showing myself to